

Motorists strike a sonic wave on Surrounded

MOTORISTS "Surrounded"

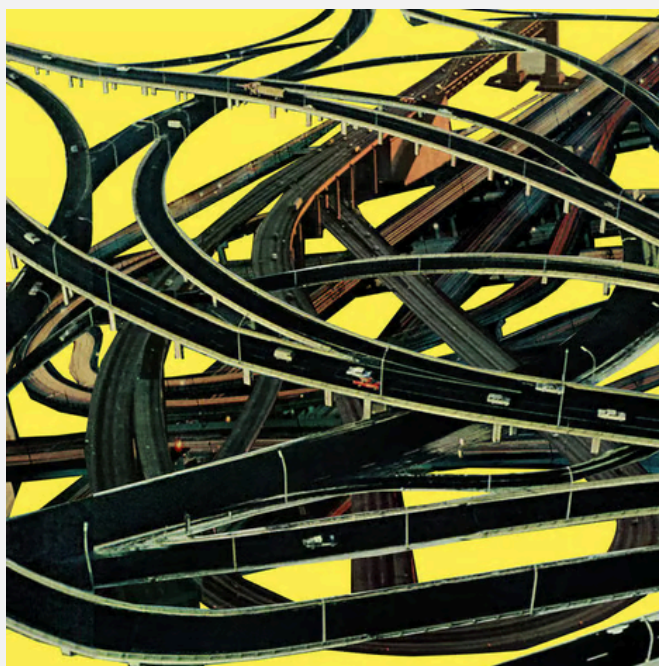
Release date: 03 September 2021

7/10

02 September 2021, 10:46

Written by *Alex Franquelli*

(ALBUMS) (MOTORISTS)



As soon as “Hidden hands” kicks in and its open chords stamp a sonic wave in your silence, you remember why we miss live gigs. Its vaguely post-punk stride proceeds at a jangle pace; as if Modern English (“I Melt With You” era) tried to imitate The Byrds. Motorists are a live creature, and that is rather obvious towards the middle of the album (“Through to you”, “New day”), but one should not underestimate the drive this Canadian trio manages to convey by means of an original take on well-crafted riffage.

Despite its relatively merry inclination, *Surrounded* has a deeper layer in which isolation as a defence mechanism – something we are all aware of these days– and disaffection permeate an otherwise elated musical texture. The contrast, however, is presented in such an honest and harmless way to strike the listener’s right chords. We are all overwhelmed and unsatisfied at the same time, critical and hypocritical, moved and impassable at the same time: we are this contrast.

Motorists as a band have been around for a few years, but its members (guitarist and vocalist Craig Fahner, drummer Jesse Locke, and bassist Matt Learoyd) have been part of the Calgary music scene far longer. After doing the 33-hour drive to the more cosmopolitan Toronto, they got involved with former enfant prodige Chandra Oppenheim (go check out her 1980’s EP *Transportation*). The rest is history.

Surrounded is far from reinventing the wheel; quite the opposite. The overall idea is that the band could benefit from pushing the envelope by

mixing of the vocals would definitely help propel the band higher up, but what we have right now is a mature trio which you would definitely appreciate beer-in-hand while carefully tapping your foot on a sticky floor.

This is a happily claustrophobic album which makes us nostalgic of the times ahead. Our floor might not be gummy, and the beer may not be warm enough, but take a look at Motorists, close your eyes and watch that stage. The music is upbeat and inspired, the band is onstage and the beer is getting comfortably warmer.

Share article



Sign up to Best Fit's Substack for regular dispatches from the world of pop culture

Subscribe

Read next

